

3.3 Families

3.3.1 Functions of families

Content	Additional information
• Differing views of the functions of families. • Parsons (page 45) functionalist perspective on primary socialisation and the stabilisation of adult personalities.	Students should be able to: • identify, describe and explain the functions of families (sexual, reproductive, economic and educational) • describe, compare and contrast a variety of sociological perspectives on the functions of families (functionalist, feminist and Marxist).